

RetailzPOS Holiday Content Plan

Halloween through New Year's, 2026 · Built for AEO visibility per the AI Search Visibility Playbook (2026-08) · Prepared September 2026

0. How this connects to what's already built

1. The season at a glance

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2.1 "Halloween Weekend Liquor Sales: How to Stock and Staff for the Biggest Party Night of October"

2.2 "Can a Costume Make Age Verification Harder? What Liquor and Smoke Shop Owners Should Know" ★ strongest AEO candidate this batch

2.3 "Halloween Candy vs. 'Adult Candy': A Cross-Merchandising Guide for Convenience Stores"

3. Thanksgiving, Black Friday, Small Business Saturday, Cyber Monday (publish by Oct 29)

3.1 "Thanksgiving Week Inventory: How Many Cases Should a Liquor Store Order Before the Holiday Rush?"

3.2 "Thanksgiving Store Hours: A Liquor Store Owner's Guide to Deciding (and Communicating) When You're Open"

3.3 "Small Business Saturday for Independent Liquor, Smoke, and Convenience Stores: A Same-Day Playbook"

3.4 "Should Your Liquor Store Run Black Friday or Cyber Monday Deals? What Actually Makes Sense for Age-Restricted Retail"

3.5 "The Case for Skipping Black Friday: Why Some of the Best Liquor Stores Don't Discount Like Big-Box Retailers"

4. Christmas, Hanukkah, and holiday gifting (publish by Nov 12-19)

4.1 "Hanukkah, Christmas, and New Year's: A December Retail Calendar for Independent Liquor and Convenience Stores"

4.2 "Gift Sets and Bundling for the Holidays: A Liquor Store Inventory Guide"

4.3 "Moolah Points as a Holiday Gift: Can Loyalty Points Be Gifted or Transferred?"

4.4 "How to Run a Holiday SMS/Email Loyalty Campaign Without Breaking SHAFT/TCPA Rules"

4.5 "Holiday Staffing for Liquor and Smoke Shops: How Hard-Block Verification Protects You When You're Short-Staffed"

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 - 5.1 "New Year's Eve Is the Biggest Single Night of the Year for Champagne and Sparkling Wine — Is Your Inventory Ready?"
 - 5.2 "New Year's Eve Age Verification: Why the Busiest, Most Chaotic Night of the Year Is Exactly When You Need a Hard Block"
6. January follow-through (publish by Dec 17)
 - 6.1 "What to Do With Leftover Holiday Inventory: A January Liquor Store Restock and Clearance Guide"
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0. How this connects to what's already built

The 90-Day Marketing Plan's Blog & SEO calendar runs through Week 13 (ending Nov 1, 2026) — it stops right before the holiday season actually starts. This plan picks up exactly where that one ends and covers Halloween through New Year's, using the same AEO rules already established for RetailzPOS:

- **One self-contained, 134-167 word answer block** in the first 2-3 sentences of each piece (AI Search Visibility Playbook, Section 4.1) — four are fully modeled below so the format is copy-paste clear.
- **FAQPage schema** on every piece, questions phrased the way a real owner would type them (Section 6.2 of the same playbook).
- **Named, credentialed authorship and a visible, accurate publish/updated date** — holiday content lives and dies by freshness signals.
- **Comparison tables and structured data above the fold**, not buried in narrative.
- Every claim tagged to a real RetailzPOS feature and one of the five personas (Danny, Farah, Ray, Priya, Sam) — nothing generic.

Publish with lead time. AI engines and Google need time to crawl, index, and start citing a page before the real search spike hits — the publish-by dates below sit 3-5 weeks ahead of each moment, not the week of.

1. The season at a glance

Moment	2026 date	Publish by
Halloween	Saturday, Oct 31	Oct 3
Thanksgiving	Thursday, Nov 26	Oct 29
Black Friday	Friday, Nov 27	Oct 29
Small Business Saturday	Saturday, Nov 28	Oct 29
Cyber Monday	Monday, Nov 30	Oct 29
Hanukkah	Sundown Fri Dec 4 – Sat Dec 12	Nov 12
Christmas	Friday, Dec 25	Nov 19
New Year’s Eve / Day	Thu Dec 31 / Fri Jan 1	Dec 3
January restock/clearance	Early Jan	Dec 17

2. Halloween (publish by Oct 3)

2.1 “Halloween Weekend Liquor Sales: How to Stock and Staff for the Biggest Party Night of October”

Type: How-to / data · **Persona:** Danny, Farah · **Pillar:** Every case, every bottle, every SKU — accounted for · **Feature:** AI reorder alerts, case-break inventory

2.2 “Can a Costume Make Age Verification Harder? What Liquor and Smoke Shop Owners Should Know” ★ strongest AEO candidate this batch

Type: FAQ / compliance · **Persona:** Ray, Danny · **Pillar:** Built for what needs an ID check · **Feature:** Hard-block age verification

Modeled direct-answer block (152 words): “Yes — costumes, face paint, and masks make visual age checks genuinely harder on Halloween weekend, and that’s exactly the night a system-enforced check matters more than a cashier’s judgment. A costume doesn’t change what’s on an ID, but it does change how confident a rushed, distracted staff member feels reading one under a wig or contact lenses. Hard-block age

verification removes that judgment call entirely: the register scans the ID itself, and the sale can't complete until it passes, regardless of what the customer is wearing or how busy the line is. For a smoke shop or liquor store expecting Halloween-weekend volume, this is the one night of the year worth double-checking that verification is actually configured to hard-block, not soft-block — because the same night that makes ID checks visually harder is also the night with the least staff time to double-check one manually."

2.3 "Halloween Candy vs. 'Adult Candy': A Cross-Merchandising Guide for Convenience Stores"

Type: How-to / merchandising · **Persona:** Farah · **Pillar:** Every case, every bottle, every SKU — accounted for

FAQ bank for this section (FAQPage schema): - Does a costume affect how age verification works at checkout? - Should a liquor store staff up for Halloween weekend like a regular Friday/Saturday, or more? - What's the busiest hour for a convenience store on Halloween night?

3. Thanksgiving, Black Friday, Small Business Saturday, Cyber Monday (publish by Oct 29)

3.1 "Thanksgiving Week Inventory: How Many Cases Should a Liquor Store Order Before the Holiday Rush?"

Type: How-to / data · **Persona:** Danny · **Pillar:** Every case, every bottle, every SKU — accounted for · **Feature:** AI reorder alerts, EDI invoicing

Modeled direct-answer block (144 words): "There's no single right number — it depends on last year's Thanksgiving-week sales for each SKU, not a generic multiplier applied across the whole shelf. The mistake most independent stores make isn't ordering too little or too much overall, it's ordering the same way for every category when Thanksgiving week actually skews hard toward a specific mix: wine and sparkling wine see the sharpest lift of the year, while spirits and beer see a smaller, steadier bump. A system that tracks real sales velocity by SKU — not a flat par level — can flag which

specific bottles are trending toward a stockout before Thanksgiving Wednesday, which is consistently the single highest-volume shopping day of the week for independent liquor retailers. The practical move: pull last year's Wednesday-before-Thanksgiving sales report by SKU today, not the week of, so there's still time to place a distributor order before it's too late."

3.2 "Thanksgiving Store Hours: A Liquor Store Owner's Guide to Deciding (and Communicating) When You're Open"

Type: FAQ / operational · **Persona:** Danny, Farah

3.3 "Small Business Saturday for Independent Liquor, Smoke, and Convenience Stores: A Same-Day Playbook"

Type: How-to · **Persona:** All · **Pillar:** Your regulars, remembered automatically · **Feature:** Moolah Points campaign builder — a same-day bonus-points push timed to Small Business Saturday specifically, since the whole day's premise (shop independent) matches the brand's positioning almost exactly

3.4 "Should Your Liquor Store Run Black Friday or Cyber Monday Deals? What Actually Makes Sense for Age-Restricted Retail"

Type: FAQ / educational · **Persona:** Danny · Ties to the pricing-never-published honesty already established — this piece can note that big-box discount-driven Black Friday norms don't map cleanly onto age-restricted, relationship-driven independent retail, without ever discussing RetailzPOS's own pricing

3.5 "The Case for Skipping Black Friday: Why Some of the Best Liquor Stores Don't Discount Like Big-Box Retailers"

Type: Thought leadership / LinkedIn byline candidate · **Persona:** Danny · Good candidate for the founder/leadership first-person format already used in the Content Book (W09-U7, W12-U7 style)

FAQ bank for this section: - What day do liquor stores sell the most wine before Thanksgiving? - Is Black Friday a big shopping day for liquor stores? - What is Small Business Saturday and does it apply to liquor stores? - Should a liquor store be open on Thanksgiving Day itself?

4. Christmas, Hanukkah, and holiday gifting (publish by Nov 12-19)

4.1 “Hanukkah, Christmas, and New Year’s: A December Retail Calendar for Independent Liquor and Convenience Stores”

Type: Pillar/hub page · **Persona:** All — this is the page every other December post links back to, and the strongest single candidate for a comprehensive, citable answer block covering the whole month at once

4.2 “Gift Sets and Bundling for the Holidays: A Liquor Store Inventory Guide”

Type: How-to · **Persona:** Danny, Farah · **Feature:** Case-break/SKU handling for bundled gift sets built from single-bottle stock

4.3 “Moolah Points as a Holiday Gift: Can Loyalty Points Be Gifted or Transferred?”

Type: FAQ · **Persona:** Danny · **Note — confirm before publishing:** this assumes point-gifting/transfer is an actual, shipped Moolah Points capability. If it isn’t currently supported, this topic should either be reframed around what is supported (e.g., gift cards funding a loyalty account) or held until the feature exists — do not publish a capability claim ahead of the product, per the standing rule against overstating features (Content Book “do not market yet” flag).

4.4 “How to Run a Holiday SMS/Email Loyalty Campaign Without Breaking SHAFT/TCPA Rules”

Type: Compliance-authority · **Persona:** Ray · Direct extension of the existing SHAFT/TCPA compliance content into a holiday-specific, timely angle — compliance reviewer sign-off required before publishing, same standing rule as the original SHAFT/TCPA piece

4.5 “Holiday Staffing for Liquor and Smoke Shops: How Hard-Block Verification Protects You When You’re Short-Staffed”

Type: Compliance · **Persona:** Ray, Danny · **Pillar:** Built for what needs an ID check

Modeled direct-answer block (139 words): “Seasonal hiring means more new, less-experienced staff working your busiest weeks of the year — and that combination is exactly when a soft-block system (one where a cashier can click past an ID prompt) creates the most risk. Hard-block age verification removes the judgment call from a brand-new hire’s first solo holiday shift: the sale physically cannot complete until a valid ID passes the check, so a missed or rushed verification isn’t possible even when the person at the register has been trained for a week, not a year. Every check is logged automatically too, so if a regulator or auditor asks about a specific transaction from your busiest week, there’s a timestamped record — not a memory of what a seasonal employee says they think they did. December is the wrong month to be relying on staff experience you don’t have yet.”

4.6 “CBD Gifting Guide Compliance: What Retailers Need to Know Before the Holiday Rush”

Type: Compliance · **Persona:** Sam · Extends the existing CBD state-by-state compliance content into the gifting season specifically — same counsel-review gate as the original CBD content

FAQ bank for this section: - Can loyalty points be given as a holiday gift? - Is it legal to ship CBD products as gifts across state lines? - How should a liquor store handle SMS marketing around the holidays without violating TCPA? - What’s the safest way to staff up for the holidays at an age-restricted store?

5. New Year's Eve and Day (publish by Dec 3)

5.1 “New Year's Eve Is the Biggest Single Night of the Year for Champagne and Sparkling Wine — Is Your Inventory Ready?”

Type: How-to / data · **Persona:** Danny · **Feature:** AI reorder alerts, case-break inventory

Modeled direct-answer block (147 words): “New Year's Eve is consistently the single highest-volume night of the year for champagne and sparkling wine sales at independent liquor stores — well above any other date, including the Thanksgiving-to-Christmas stretch. That concentration into one night, rather than spread across a season, is what makes NYE the single easiest night to either sell out of a popular sparkling SKU by 4pm or end the night with a walk-in cooler full of unsold stock that doesn't move again until next December. A reorder system built on real sales velocity — not a fixed par level — should already be flagging which specific sparkling wine SKUs are trending ahead of last year's pace by mid-December, giving enough lead time to place one more distributor order before New Year's Eve itself. Waiting until December 28th to check sparkling wine stock is checking it after the ordering window that could still fix a shortfall has already closed.”

5.2 “New Year's Eve Age Verification: Why the Busiest, Most Chaotic Night of the Year Is Exactly When You Need a Hard Block”

Type: Compliance · **Persona:** All · **Pillar:** Built for what needs an ID check

FAQ bank for this section: - What's the best-selling alcohol category on New Year's Eve? - How far in advance should a liquor store order champagne for New Year's? - Does age verification need to be stricter on New Year's Eve than a normal night?

6. January follow-through (publish by Dec 17)

6.1 “What to Do With Leftover Holiday Inventory: A January Liquor Store Restock and Clearance Guide”

Type: How-to · **Persona:** Danny, Farah · **Feature:** AI reorder alerts — the same system that flagged what to order in December can flag what’s now overstocked in January

This is a deliberate, small but meaningful signal: publishing real content into the first week of January (rather than going quiet after Dec 25) is itself a freshness/consistency signal AI engines and Google both reward, and it shows a buyer researching mid-January that the blog isn’t a seasonal-only operation.

7. Bonus — the next wave after this one

“Super Bowl Sunday Prep for Liquor and Convenience Stores: Why the Biggest Game Night Starts Weeks Earlier” — outside this plan’s Halloween-through-New-Year’s scope, but worth flagging now: Super Bowl Sunday (Feb 2027) is arguably the single biggest single-day sales event of the year for beer specifically, bigger than any date in this document for that one category. Worth its own short content push in mid-January, timed the same way everything above is — 3-4 weeks ahead of the actual date, not the week of.

8. Production notes

- **Video pairing:** per the AI Search Visibility Playbook’s new YouTube workstream, the Thanksgiving inventory piece (3.1) and the NYE champagne piece (5.1) are the two strongest candidates for a paired long-form YouTube video — both have a concrete, data-driven direct-answer that translates well into the “state the answer in the first 30 seconds, then walk through why” video structure already established.

- **Compliance gate:** every piece touching age verification, SHAFT/TCPA, or CBD (2.2, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 5.2) requires compliance reviewer sign-off before publishing, same standing rule as the rest of RetailzPOS's compliance content.
- **Don't publish 4.3 (Moolah Points gifting) until the underlying capability is confirmed** — flagged explicitly in Section 4.3 above.
- **Internal linking:** 4.1 (the December hub page) should link to every other piece in Sections 3-5; every seasonal piece should link back to 4.1. This is what turns individual posts into the kind of topic cluster AI engines synthesize a single confident answer from, rather than isolated pages.